

the screen of your phone or tablet all the time while you use it, you better make it well worth the effort.

Battery: If there is one single thing that matters beyond everything else on a tablet or smartphone then it's the battery capacity of the device. Devices try to strike a delicate balance between core processing power and power efficiency, and it's a never-ending struggle. The fact that portable power banks are getting popular as a phone and tablet accessory is reason enough to believe that our smart devices (especially our smartphones) don't make it through the day without a little recharging in between. iPads have the best battery life, among tablets, in our experience, while smartphone battery lives all continue to disappoint. We can't stress this point enough -- the higher your smartphone or tablet's mAh number (battery capacity), the better for your peace of mind.

ytknows

Suddenly thinness, lightness, resolution are now minor points. I bet every review of a PC over the next few months is going to focus on battery life, and a comparison with the MBA.

Posted on Jun 17, 2013 | 8:35 PM

Triple.f

Actually, I always thought battery life is more important than a retina display when it comes to the MBA. If I have a portable notebook I want good battery life and not a device which struggles with the requirements of a retina display. I would much rather use the power of the machine for actual "tasks" than just a sharper display. Look at the 13" RMBP. The display sucks up all the resources of the machine and lacks even then....

Posted on Jun 17, 2013 | 8:38 PM

ytknows

Different people have different preferences in a laptop, there are good and bad things about all of the high end laptops. There is no one single "best laptop for everyone" at the moment. But when it comes to laptop reviews, the goalposts are set at wherever Apple currently puts them.

Posted on Jun 17, 2013 | 8:42 PM

SilenceInTheLibrary

I doubt the goalposts can't change. If something comes out that's a) thinner, b) has better battery life, c) has a better display, or d) has better performance while retaining the same battery life, then I'm certain they'd be more than happy to praise it.

Apple is just known for having extremely nice hardware. I've yet to find a PC whose trackpad matches up to an Apple laptop's. Due to the fact that I'm doing more and more linux development, I'm honestly considering getting something like this (due to the long battery life) and perhaps dual or tri-booting with Mint and Windows.

Posted on Jun 17, 2013 | 9:06 PM